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Company: **Barclays**
Job Profile: **Technology Developer**
Offer Type: **Placement Only**
CTC: **13.5 LPA**
Location: **Pune**
Process Date: **26th-29th July 2025**

Before getting into this interview experience please remember, placement is a game of both hard work and luck. After rejections from multiple companies, Barclays was the one where I finally got placed. It's truly never too late to start. For some companies, I couldn't clear the coding round, while for others, I made it to the second technical round. I even reached the HR round for a few, and Barclays was the one where I cleared all of them. With each company that comes and goes, you'll learn a lot, so just keep believing in yourself. Always remember, if it's not this one, then God has something better in store for you. I know getting rejected repeatedly can be disheartening and breaking, but do remember: *Champions aren't those who never fall, they're the ones who never stay down.*

Placement Process:

The entire Barclays drive had three rounds: starting with the Online Assessment (OA) round, followed by a Technical Interview, and then a Techno-HR round. There was no GPA cutoff this year; however, I would still recommend maintaining a GPA above 8.5 to always be on the safer side. The pre-placement talk took place just before the technical round, unlike the usual PPTs that occur for all candidates before the OA. Barclays conducts its PPT for candidates shortlisted only from the OA. Please be attentive and make sure to note down the points they mention during the PPT, as it helps you prepare well about the company. A company will always prefer a candidate who is well-aware of its mission, values, and objectives.

1. **Online Assessment** [133 students appeared for this round]

It was conducted on 26th July 2025 at 11am. The OA round lasted **90 minutes** and included **15 questions**: 13 MCQs on CS fundamentals (specifically **OOPS and DBMS**), 1 moderate DSA question, and 1 easy SQL question.

In the CS fundamentals part, they particularly focused on Java output-based questions, some of which involved recursion and inheritance. Some MCQs were weighted differently (2, 4, 5, or 6 marks), so it was crucial to get the 6-marker ones correct. One question I remember involved several abstract classes and functions. The main function attempted to instantiate these abstract classes, which would lead to a compilation error, as an abstract class can never be instantiated. This question was lengthy, but if you looked carefully, the answer was obvious at a glance. It was important not to get such questions wrong, especially since they were 6-markers. Another question asked for the default values of instance variables of type boolean and int, the answers being false and 0 respectively. There was also a question on try catch blocks where I had to determine the output. One Java function involved finding the maximum value and its correct output. Additionally, there was a question that provided options for SQL queries, and I had to select the correct one based on a given table schema. It's really important to read each question properly and carefully, without missing any details.

For the SQL question, I was given a single table and had to find customer IDs and calculate a final amount that was 50% more than customer’s salary who had a major accident, had a savings account, and an active salary and insurance account . It was an easy question where we were just required to apply multiple AND conditions based on the listed criteria.

The DSA question was similar to : [Lexicographical String]

Approach: I used a brute-force approach and managed to pass all the test cases. First, I constructed a result string with a length equal to len1+len2-1 (where len1 is the size of str1 and len2 is the size of str2). For every index i in str1 where the value was 'T', I ensured that the substring starting at i in the result exactly matched str2. If any conflict occurred during this placement, I returned an empty string. After placing all 'T'-based substrings, I filled the remaining uninitialized positions with 'a'. Next, for each 'F' position in str1, I checked if the corresponding substring in the result matched str2. If it did (which it shouldn't), I tried to change at least one unfixed character in that range by incrementing it, as long as it wasn't already locked from a 'T' placement. If fixing wasn't possible, I returned an empty string. Finally, the result string was returned after satisfying all 'T' and 'F' constraints.

Most of the students had completed the DSA and SQL questions, so everything boiled down to the MCQ round, which decided who would proceed to the further rounds.

2. **Technical Interview Round** [37 candidates appeared for this round]

Stay calm, be composed, and trust in what you've studied. The interviewer will ask questions that are important and showcase your problem-solving abilities, not random, vague ones.

My interview began with the interviewer asking for my introduction. It's crucial to prepare your introduction in a way that clearly highlights your strong topics; with a bit of luck, you might only get questions on those areas, but be prepared for everything. The interviewer then asked me to rate my development, DSA, SQL, and database skills. After that, he started by asking me to write a few SQL queries: first, to find the Nth record from a table, and then to find the 7th highest salary from a given set of records. Following this, he asked about the order of execution for any given SQL query. For better clarity, refer to following article Execution Order of SQL Query

Next, he asked several questions about databases, specifically the reasons for choosing a particular database and under what circumstances. Essentially, he wanted to test my capability to implement the appropriate database for a given problem and the reasoning behind that choice. Ensure you provide proper reasons and clarity for your database selection. He also asked how I would optimize a given query search.

After this, he shifted to my resume and asked me to explain my internship project and exactly what I did in it and what were the various challenges I faced in it, which was the most critical bug/error I faced and how did I eliminate it. Always be prepared for questions about your **project's goals, objectives, architecture, challenges faced, advantages, disadvantages, the reason for choosing your tech stack, the various alternatives to your tech stacks, possible scalable solutions**, and what you learned from it. For every question you're asked, ensure you explain the concept first, followed by an example, and then a real-life application, along with its advantages, disadvantages, and any possible concerns. For one of my projects, I was asked to explain how JWT Tokens works at a core level, followed by a detailed explanation of RBAC . Make sure to explain using a pen and paper, as this demonstrates the clarity of your understanding.

From another project, they asked for the reason behind choosing the IPFS system over Docker, how I would ensure the confidentiality of a user uploading a file to my application, and how I would check if a file had been tampered with. For this, I tried to explain the working of IPFS in detail. As my resume showcased more of my machine learning capabilities, they asked for the reasons behind choosing various algorithms, what would have happened if I had chosen a different algorithm, and how I decide which algorithm is best for a model. What are the various steps involved in deciding which algorithm is best for a given problem. They also asked for the reason behind choosing ROC over accuracy and sensitivity. Always be honest with your answers; if you don't know something, try to relate it to the most relevant concept. They want to test how you react in such situations, so explain your thought process and how you would tackle the issue. To my surprise, I wasn't asked a single OOPS question throughout my interview. Communicate with your interviewer and ask for hints if you get stuck on a question. The more vocal you are with your thoughts, the better idea the interviewer will get about how confident you are with your answers. There's no need to worry even if you're wrong; just stay calm.

He then asked me, being "more of an ML guy," how I would work on a leader’s project with different requirements. In such a situation, you need to showcase your fast learning ability and how well you can adapt to new technologies. I tried to answer by saying that even though I am an ML guy, I have built a few MERN stack-based projects along with projects that use Python with Django, so shifting to a different tech stack would actually help me learn even more new things. I also mentioned that ML is something I am quite familiar with, more inclined towards, and have always loved developing projects around.

At the end, the interviewer asked if I had any questions. I had thoroughly reviewed their PPT, which mentioned that GenAI and ML domains are areas they are currently exploring. So, I asked them about the current stage of Barclays' use of GenAI at a production level and how a new intern could get into such teams and collaborate with everyone.

3. **<u>Techno HR round</u>** [21 appeared for this round]

The way the first round went for me, I didn't expect to be shortlisted for the next one. I was actually heading home when I found out I was selected for the Techno-HR round and that my interview was in the next 10 minutes. I came running back, calmed myself down, and got ready for it. This round, which was the penultimate one, lasted about 50 minutes. It started with a brief introduction of myself, where I was asked to mention who I am in real life, what qualities set me apart from others, things I like and dislike, the projects I've built with their detailed descriptions, and their social impact. I was asked the following questions:

- Tell me about a situation where you were ashamed of yourself.
- What was a time in your project when your teammates had to suffer because of you?
- Suppose one of your teammates is not willing to work with you; how would you react in that situation?
- Describe a situation in life where you had to make a decision for your team that wasn’t welcomed and what was its impact?
- What was that one moment in life when you earned the respect of others?
- Mention a situation where you had to form a cross-dynamic team (people of different ethnicities and age groups), and how did you coordinate with them?

- Suppose you have a conflicting idea that doesn't really work well with your project, but you've worked quite hard on it and want it to be incorporated. However, other teammates aren't willing to accept it; what would you do?
- Describe a moment when you were a liability for the team—basically, you were present but couldn't contribute anything.
- While working in the internship, was there a time when you faced a situation where you got a sudden, revised deadline that was very difficult for you to manage?
- What were some of the major challenges you faced while developing your projects?
- You were given very less time to develop a project by your manager; what would you do in that situation?

Barclays strongly believes in its **RISES values**: Respect, Integrity, Service, Excellence, and Stewardship.

At the very end, they called 16 people to the Conference Room, where they dramatically announced that these were the individuals who had cheated in the Barclays placement and were therefore "invited to come and join Barclays :) " It turned out to be a small prank on their part, a way to try and scare us. I was honestly filled with so many emotions; tears started rolling down as, after so many rejections and moments of self-doubt, I was finally able to crack Barclays. It really hammered home the idea that fortune favors the brave. People often say that luck contributes a bit to placements, and I do agree with that, but ultimately, you need to put in so much hard work that your efforts clearly shine through, helping you clear each and every round. It's that consistent dedication that truly makes the difference in the end.

Useful Tips:

1) It's never too late to start, but the moment you do, ensure you give your 100%.
2) Never compare yourself to others. Always remember, if someone is good at a particular thing, you'll be good at another.
3) Have your fundamentals and basics cleared and spend as much as time you can on improving those skills
4) DSA is a mandatory thing to learn, without saying.
5) You won't be able to survive just on your tech skills; you need your communication skills so you can portray yourself effectively.
6) Learn development properly, no need to gpt hamesha. There were instances where few of my friends were asked to write a part of their code that they implemented in their projects
7) In an interview, always be true to yourself. Don't fake anything you don't know. Know your resume in and out.
8) Companies prefer candidates who have interned before because it tends to give you an idea of how exactly you'll work in a larger organisation.

9) Trust the process. There will be times when you will be upset , you will self-doubt your skills, knowledge, and everything you've learned. During this time, stay motivated, have good friends around you, and talk to your family. No need to worry about things that haven't happened.
10) During your interviews, be confident in your answers. Your interviewer will try to trick you.
11) Overall you need to be good in **Oops , DBMS , SQL , OS, CN** and all those **concepts** and **techstack** you have mentioned in your resume. **System Designing** is a hot topic.
12) Don't neglect the **Aptitude** section. **IndiaBIX** is a good platform where you can practice it. Also, refer to **GeeksforGeeks** for puzzles; they might get asked sometimes.
13) Placement kaafi lamba process hai, and you will realise you are in a good college. Companies aayengi, guys, so eventually you will get placed.

Study material I referred to during my prep:

1) System Design : If you have good amount of time to study system design in depth
2) System Design : If you are short on time
3) DSA Striver's Sheet
4) One of the finest DSA based yt channels for concept clarity
5) CP Sheet by TLE Eliminators
6) Oops in CPP
7) Oops in Java
8) DBMS : Codehelp - Lecture Notes + Slides
9) Google Drive for necessary pdfs
10) Practise SQL questions
11) CPP secret
12) GFG and InterviewBits are the best platforms for referring any interview based questions on any topic and do give it a glance before you go for your interviews

You are your own warrior, and you are here to claim that one seat in your dream company.

Feel free to contact me on my Whatsapp number: +91 83289 32885 or connect with me on LinkedIn

Sayonara!!